

32 Megapixel

The full frame Canon 1Ds Mark IV DSLR having a 32MP sensor rumoured to be launched by the time you read this

Dual-GPU laptop

Origin Eon 18 gaming laptop boasts of an 18.4 inch full HD widescreen alongwith dual Nvidia GeForce GTX 280M GPUs

MFD test



Canon Pixma MP276

TX600FW was observed to be the fastest in terms of copying, taking only 28 seconds and 32 seconds to print five copies in black and white and colour respectively. Quality was not compromised despite such fast printing.

Epson TX600FW was the fastest at scanning a document at 300 dpi to the computer – just 16 seconds.

Ricoh's Aficio SP C232SF, a colour laser printer, gave a photo quality that was almost as good as the best inkjet printers.

MONOCHROME LASER MFD

Monochrome laser MFDs are basically targeted at small to medium office set-ups. The MFDs that we tested in this category have a large footprint in terms of space occupied as compared with their inkjet counterparts. Speed is of utmost importance as these devices are meant for

large volume jobs. Almost all of them had fax and network functionality.

Features

Canon had the most MFDs in this category as well. We tested its imageCLASS series of MFDs – MF4680, MF4380dn and MF4350d. The design elements are common in all three MFDs since they belong to the same series. While the output trays and operational panels remain the same in all three, we notice a definite change in the input tray and ADFs. The MF4380dn has the strongest ADF feeder tray and the document collecting tray has an interesting design which raises the paper once it comes out of the ADF. MF4350d has the best paper cassette among the three while the MF4380dn has a slimmer paper cassette with a cover on top to prevent dust from collecting. Although manual feeder trays are present on both

the MF3480dn and MF4680, we felt that it does not serve any purpose in MFDs that are meant for volume printing.

The operational panel on Canon MFDs were the most populated with buttons for various functionalities. There are a wider range of options for the fax and telephone functions. Apart from the number pad there were speed dial buttons located on the operational panel. Navigating the options on the LCD screen is quite easy. ADF makes copying and scanning more efficient when you have separate sheets of paper rather than a book. MF4680 has a USB drive support which allows you to scan images directly to a pen drive.

We also got Ricoh's Aficio SP1100SF and SPC232SF MFDs to test. Design wise, these were the most pleasing MFDs as the flatbed scanner and ADF portion were perched respectably above the printer segment. In the SP 1100SF the narrow base of the printer curves outwards to connect to a wider top end which houses the flatbed scanner and the ADF. Whereas the SP C232SF laser MFD has a scanner and ADF setup that can be slid backward to allow easy collection of the papers in the output tray.

Navigating the operational panel on Ricoh MFDs was a big pain. There is very little flexibility in the operations. Compared to Canon, Xerox and Brother MFDs we had



Brother DCP 7030



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